

Request for Information (RFI)

15BNAS26RFI000014

Career/Work Readiness Certificate Program (CWRCP)

Background

The Federal Bureau of Prisons (FBOP) is an agency of the U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) responsible for the custody and care of approximately 155,000 Adults in Custody (AICs) housed across 127 facilities nationwide. The FBOP Education Branch provides literacy, vocational, post-secondary, and reentry programming designed to enhance successful reintegration and reduce recidivism. While High School Equivalency (HSE) credentials remain foundational, the Bureau recognizes the need for additional evidence-based workforce readiness programming aligned with employer expectations.

The proposed acquisition is classified under NAICS Code 611710 – Educational Support Services.

Purpose

The FBOP is conducting market research to identify qualified vendors capable of providing an evidence-based Career/Work Readiness Certificate Program (CWRCP) designed for adult learners in a correctional setting. The program must include classroom-based instruction and paper-based testing (PBT), align with College and Career Readiness Standards supported by the U.S. Department of Education, support the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA), and culminate in a portable, employer-recognized credential certifying skill attainment.

Scope of Services

1. Curriculum and Instructional Materials

- The curriculum must include evidence-based instructional modules addressing:
 - Math/Technical Skills
 - Literacy/Reading
 - Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication
 - Workplace and Soft Skills
- Additional requirements:
 - Available in English and Spanish
 - Measurable work objectives and goals
 - Pre- and post-testing at each level
 - Clear criteria for completion and achievement levels
 - Student progress and skills analysis reports

- Universal Design for Learning (UDL) approach
- Section 508 compliance
- Printed textbooks, workbooks, assessments, and teacher resources

2. Assessment and Scoring Services

- The contractor must:
 - Provide scoring services for all assessments
 - Process scoring within 7 business days of receipt
 - Provide student score reports and credentials within 10 days
 - Provide group statistical reporting for institutional and national use
 - Support student transfers between institutions and track cumulative progress

3. Data Security & Confidentiality

Assessment records and student data remain the property of FBOP and must be treated as confidential. The vendor must comply with FISMA, the Privacy Act, NIST SP 800-series controls, FIPS standards, DOJ IT Security Standards, and Authority to Operate (ATO) requirements where applicable. Vendors must demonstrate written testing integrity, data protection protocols, and credential portability assurances.

4. Training and Support

- The vendor must:
 - Provide institutional training for instructional staff
 - Offer ongoing support Monday–Friday 8:00 AM – 10:00 PM EST and Saturday 8:00 AM – 7:00 PM EST
 - Provide quarterly invoicing and reporting

Vendor Capability Information Requested

- Interested vendors should provide:
 - Company name, UEI, and SAM.gov registration status
 - Business size under NAICS 611710
 - Description of evidence-based methodology supporting workforce readiness outcomes
 - Alignment documentation with College and Career Readiness Standards and WIOA
 - Description of assessment design and paper-based testing capabilities
 - Evidence of employer recognition and portability of credentials
 - Experience providing services in correctional or institutional settings
 - Data security controls and compliance certifications (FISMA, NIST, etc.)
 - Description of training model and support infrastructure
 - Estimated pricing model (per assessment, per student, or other structure)

Period of Performance

The anticipated period of performance is one (1) fiscal year (12 months), with potential future option periods.

Disclaimer

This RFI is issued solely for information and planning purposes and does not constitute a solicitation. The Government will not reimburse any costs associated with responding to this RFI. Responses should be clear and concise and not exceed 25 pages, excluding attachments.